Seated single-leg band curl

Knee flexion / 8-12 each side



START / heel forward



FINISH / heel drawn back

MAIN: Hamstrings bend the knee, drawing the heel back.

SECONDARY: Gastrocnemius can assist knee flexion. Ankle-positioning muscles hold the foot position; hip muscles keep the thigh aligned.

BASE / SUPPORT: Chair, opposite planted foot and trunk muscles steady the pelvis. The working thigh stays supported.

01 / Check the setup

Use a stable chair and a low anchor in front. Attach a manufacturer-approved ankle cuff to a light band, clear of chair legs and the other foot.

02 / Set the base and brace

Sit tall with the working thigh supported. Start with that heel forward and the knee softly extended; keep the ankle comfortable.

03 / Move with control

Exhale and slide or draw the heel back by bending the knee. Keep the thigh and pelvis quiet rather than pulling with the hip.

04 / Limit the range and return

Use only a comfortable arc with enough clearance under the chair. Return slowly; do not allow a sudden recoil or locked knee.

WATCH FOR: If the chair shifts, cuff slips, knee hurts or pelvis rocks, stop and reset; use less tension. EASIER: Rehearse the heel slide without a band. Do not add resistance until the cuff and anchor are appropriate.

Soft joints, normal breathing. Colours describe exercise roles, not measured activation. Hidden muscles are named in text. No fixed resistance is prescribed.

Stop for pain, new numbness or weakness, dizziness, loss of grip, moving supports or damaged bands. Keep the recoil path clear. Follow manufacturer limits and individual clinical restrictions.

Sources: ACE - Resistance-band workout builder; NHS - Strength exercises. Full source links: project100.fit/downloads/kinetics/index.html